MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF COMMUNICATION STUDIES

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS

COMM 1101: COMMUNICATION SKILLS I

DATE: Thursday, September 02, 2021 **TIME: 3 Hours**

(2-5 PM)

Instruction: Answer **all** questions.

QUESTION 1

In the context of communication:

A. What is noise? **(2 marks)**

B. Explain the linkage between noise and encoding/decoding of the message. **(2 marks)**

C. State and define the 3 forms of noise in the communication process. **(6 marks)**

D. Identify what form of noise is in play when a discussion is interrupted by the following scenarios:

i. A group of students talking loudly **(1 mark)**

ii. A helicopter flying overheard **(1 mark)**

iii. Sound of cars passing by **(1 mark)**

iv. People dancing outside your classroom **(1 mark)**

v. Someone standing too close **(1 mark)**

vi. Hot sun **(1 mark)**

vii. Thinking about lunch **(1 mark)**

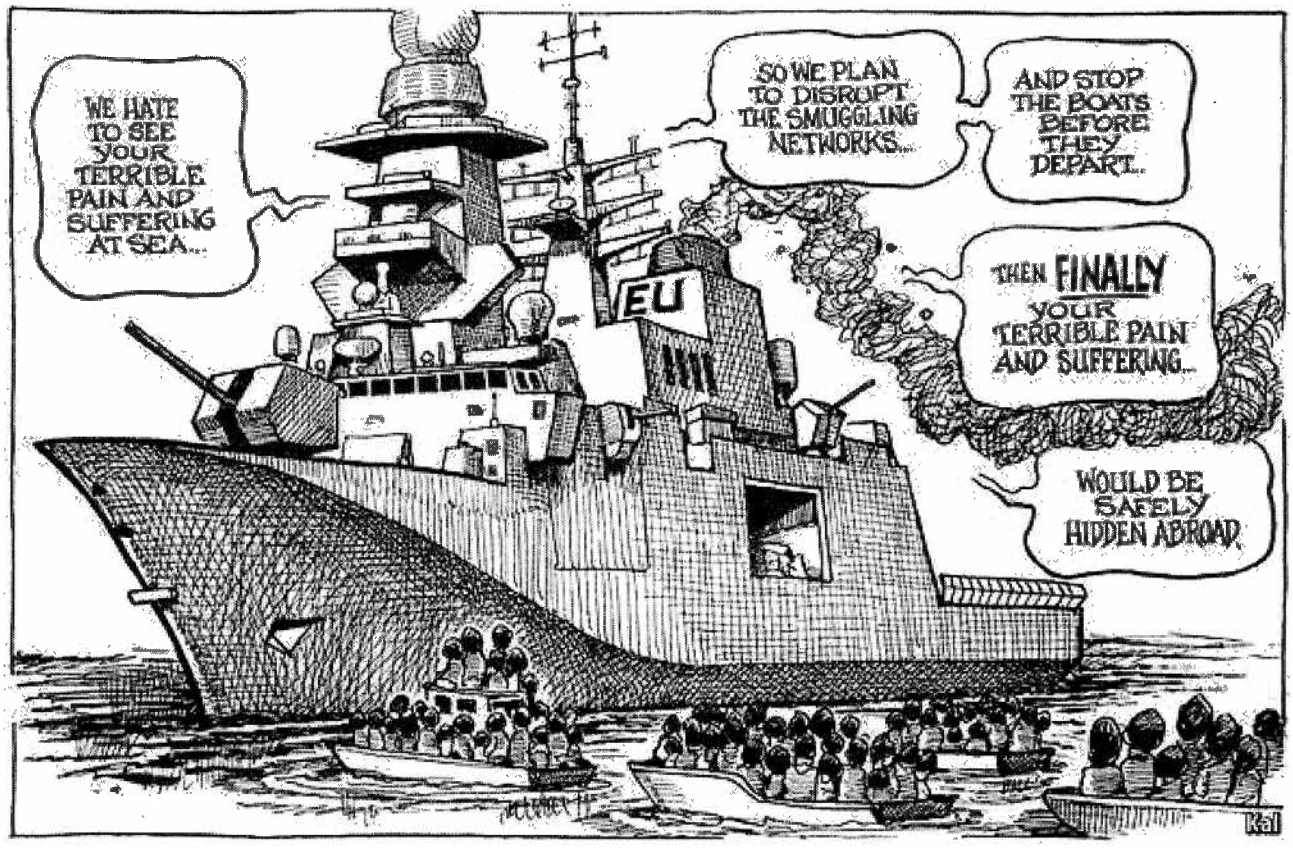
viii. Thinking about a loved one **(1 mark)**

ix. Mispronunciation of a word **(1 mark)**

x. A different interpretation of the word 'soon' **(1 mark)**

QUESTION 2

An essay must have certain basics such as thesis statement, introduction, body and conclusion. In particular the topic sentence is a key sentence that provides a focus for a supporting paragraph. The topic sentence is most often found at the beginning of a paragraph though occasionally it may feature in the middle or at the end of the paragraph. Study the diagram; read the essay below and answer questions that follow:



The Inevitability of Migration

You have already heard much about migration. Thank you. You probably have formed an opinion about, thank you; and you probably feel a bit frustrated by the current horrific death stories of migrants dying enmass while attempting to cross the huge bordering seas between continents. I appreciate. Regardless of what your opinion is, migration is an inevitable process of human evolution.

I am talking from a historical point of view about migration as an essential phenomena in human history. I am talking of myths and tales of migration. I am putting them in current perspectives and hoping that you will in the end develop a rational opinion on this complex and difficult subject matter. I am making it simple for you, since, like it or not , migration is the inevitable of life that leads to cultural evolution of man. If Aristotle thought of man as a social animal, I may as well add that man is in essence a migrating creature, and is ready to die for it.

None of us would be here today if it was not for man's inherent tendency to migrate. We probably would not have racial diversity, if some small, dark-skinned, intelligent creatures had not been curious about what was beyond the periphery of Africa many thousands of years ago. These little creatures walked across the desert and into south Asia - the area of today's Middle East. From there, these migrants split up, some going towards southeast Asia, some going west, following the sun to Europe.

Considering that the very first steps of our ancestors was movement, why would you be xenophobic towards migration? You hear tales of leading historical archetypal figures of

migration such as Moses. Exodus the movement of God's people . Moses and his people suffered in Egypt enslaved by people of a different faith and somewhat different ethnic group. When he and his followers could endure no more, they set out across the desert, where they wandered for many years. They suffered the desert's heat and cold, the loss of some of their group, a failure of faith, the lack of water.

As Mexican intellectual Jose Vasconcelos(1925), prophetically said in his essay, *La Raza Cosmica,* or *the cosmic race,* "The days of pure whites, the victors of today, are as numbered as the days of their predecessors. Having fulfilled their destiny of mechanizing the world, they themselves have set, without knowing it, the basis for the new period: The period of the fusion and mixing of all peoples. " It sounds apocalyptic but it is just human nature that migration is inevitable. It happened even more before Joses mechanization statement. It is part of who we are.

A. Identify the thesis statement of this essay. **(2 marks)**
B. Differentiate the topic and treatment in it. **(3marks)**
C. What are the topic sentences for each paragraph in the body of the essay? **(3 marks)**
D. What type of introduction has this essay used? **(1 mark)**
E. Study the visual communication accompanying the essay. Taking that as an inspiration, how would you conclude this essay using a different style? **(5 marks)**
F. If you were to use another form of introduction to the essay what type would it be? Mention it and give an example by writing one in relation to topic of the essay above. **(5 marks)**
G. What type of conclusion is in the essay? **(1 mark)**

QUESTION 3

Abraham Maslow's model of human needs was developed in the early 1950's. It was devised to illustrate his idea that people are driven by needs to act in the way do. He believed that we require the satisfaction of certain physical and psychological needs for our lives to be complete. These needs were ordered in a hierarchy in order to show their relative importance. Those at the base are very basic and are needed by all of us. Maslow believed that some needs are more significant than others and that people will try to satisfy those basic needs before they shift to higher order needs.

A. Explain, at what stage of the listening process is Maslow's model relevant and for what purpose? **(5 marks)**

B. Using examples, write an essay explaining how Maslow's model can be used to assess your listening capability to lectures as a student at Mzuzu University. **(15 marks)**

QUESTION 4

According to APA referencing style:

A. What is meant by parenthetical citation? **(2 marks)**

B. State any **two** reasons for acknowledging sources of information in academic writing **(2 marks)**

C. Compare and contrast reference list and bibliography. **(4 marks)**

D. What is common between a direct quotation and a paraphrase of the same text by the same author? **(2 marks)**

E. Imagine that you have written an essay in which you have incorporated information from the sources listed below. Draw up the list of references for your

essay. **(12 marks)**

Book title: Living Things

Editor: B.M. Backson

Publisher: Longman

Place of publication: London

Year of publication: 2002

Title of article: Human Rights

Author: B. Mwale

Newspaper: Daily Times

Date of publication: 20 April, 2006

Page where article found:8

Book title: Sweet Dreams

Authors: A. Gondwe and P. Banda

Publisher: McMillan

Place of publication: New York

Year of publication: 1988

QUESTION 5

A report has some elements of congruency to an essay.

A. Compare and contrast a report and an essay giving at least **three** brief explanations for each part. **(6 marks)**

B. Schematic reports have a format containing various sections. Using an outlining note taking style, write down the format of a report, indicating in brief the basic contents under each sectional heading as given below: **(12marks)**

i) Cover

ii) Title Page

iii) Letter of Transmittal (Cover Letter)

iv) Table of Contents

v) List of Illustrations

vi) Acknowledgements

vii) Executive Summary (Abstract)

viii) Introduction

ix) Report Body (Findings)

x) Conclusion

xi) Recommendations

xii) References or Works Cited

END OF QUESTION PAPER